EXPLORING A DISEMBODIED VOICE IN SURROUND SOUND MEDIA SPACE

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ABSTRACT

This paper explores ideas related to Electronic Voice Phenomena (EVP) and the disembodied voice in mediated space as a starting point to develop a 5.1 surround sound radio art work. It documents the author's creative processes and 5.1 production techniques that include a type of deconstruction of spatiality and fluctuating relationship with sonic "reality" and fiction. Moreover, the paper explores the notion of varying mediated "distance" between the listener and the recorded voice in terms of both the "length" or transformative effect of the audio chain and/or communication system and "time" that can be heard as a technologically related chronological aspect.

INTRODUCTION

> *When I turn my radio on, I hear a whole chorus of death rattles … from voices that have been severed from the body so long that no one can remember who they belong to, or whether they belonged to anyone at all …*
>
> - Gregory Whitehead

> *I began listening to the sounds around me from all directions and imagined how such sounds, and in just such complexity, could be transmuted into music. It excited and stimulated me to think about the possibility of such a metamorphosis and I began to imagine the invention of new devices that would make spatial music possible …*
>
> - Edgard Varèse

This paper examines my short form work entitled, "A Disembodied Voice In [5.1 Surround Sound Radio] Space" (duration 7'16") that combines elements of Whitehead's disembodied radiophonic voice with Varèse's notion of spatial music. In many ways this work can be thought of a meta-referencing piece that explores sonic space and the potentially disconcerting schizophonic and metaphysical aspects of the medium.

BACKGROUND

On 6 December 1877, Thomas A. Edison unwittingly dislocated the voice from the body by recording his voice onto a tinfoil roll. This psychophysical complexity was further exasperated by the development of the radio, where voices seemed to travel through - or manifest from - thin air, like spirits. This perceived phenomena sparked a fascination with the idea of receiving the voices of "phantoms" on radio. Ernst Fisk in 1930, predicting "an even more wonderful [radio] age ahead of us; we cannot exhaust the infinite," (Ernst 1930a) also speculated about the possibility of talking to the dead using the wireless (Ernst 1930b). Moreover, Antonin Artaud's 1947 radio play, *To Have Done with the Judgment of God* explored the idea of "a body without organs" (Artaud 1976) and William Burroughs's work has explored the theme of the interconnection between technology and magic.[1] More recently, John Potts's radio piece, *Castlereagh Street* (2000) was based on a ghost who "haunts the corner of Castlereagh and Market streets in Sydney (Australia) and experiences the world primarily through sound" (ABC Classic FM 2000), while Allen S. Weiss has written about the "themes of modernism … occur[ing] as a matter of course in the phantasmic realm of radio" (Weiss 1995).

The advent of these new mediums (sound recordings and wireless transmission) also gave birth to Electronic Voice Phenomena (EVP), a belief that elements of the noise found on the radio [and in sound recordings] resemble "voices of the dead and other discarnate entities" (Baruss 2001).

After four years of experiments, Swedish painter and documentary filmmaker Friedrich Jürgenson detailed how he could contact the spiritual world using standard radio receivers, in his book entitled *Radio Contact with the Dead* (Sconce 2000). Susy Smith's research into the development of Jürgenson's EVP work claims that almost from the beginning of his experiments, Jürgenson had heard one insistent female voice repeatedly pleading,

[1] For example in *Cities of the Red Night*, missing persons are located via sound recordings of their environment and randomly cut in recordings of the subject's voice.

"Make contact through radio" (Smith 1977) which led him to utilise radio. Later Konstantin Raudive also used radio to listen to the dead; by tuning "from one end of the wavelength-scale to the other" Raudive claimed a voice would suddenly indicate when to stop saying "Now" or "Make recording!" (Sconce 2000). Raudive's recordings of radio spirit voices include their cries to be listened to via radio.

> Please radio!
> Bit by bit only through radio.
> Just let the radio loose!
> Speak through radio!
> Through the radio
> What a rascal, switch on the radio! (Sconce 2000)

For many, broadcasts and sound recordings seem to reach across the fabric of reality to form an interface between this world and another.

AESTHETIC AND CONCEPTUAL STANDPOINTS

While the theme of radio and the voices of the dead - or spirits - have emerged time and time again within radio works, very little radio art work (that explores this theme) has been developed to utilise 5.1 surround sound production and broadcast techniques. With "A Disembodied Voice In [5.1 Surround Sound Radio] Space" I explore the idea of a disembodied voice within the added dimension of 5.1 surround sound, as opposed to the monophonic or stereophonic "acoustic frame" or "sound stage" that has been chiefly used to date. The aim is also to create an immersive sonic environment that takes the listener inside its constructed sonic world, where the disembodied voice thematically develops the notion of the formless body and instantaneous travel via thought and desire.

1.1. Treatment

The work - while it contains sparse passages of dialogue - is not driven by text narrative, but aims to create impressions much in the same way as poetry does. It is a form of sonic poetry where language, sound effects (including location recordings) and musical composition have equal importance and counterpoint each other to convey meaning that is highly individualistic for each listener.

In this poetic style the work's use of fragmented text narrative is employed so as to help to form sections and a framework between which audio segues propel the work along new trajectories. This audio treatment and framework also assists the development of the theme of the formless body and instantaneous travel via thought and desire (i.e. the listener suddenly and seemingly emerges in the new location with the Disembodied Voice character).

The work's sound world is an aural space that is both influenced by reality and distorted by the idea of the spirit world. To reflect this imagined sonority I have blended techniques from electronic music, musique concrète and audio documentary. So while the location recordings may be encoded with natural sounds and have a coherent aural image, when these recordings are treated and/or juxtaposed in this manner, the resulting balance helped to form the work's pluralistic sound world that is the confluence between this world and an imagined other world. This was also achieved by creating an interplay between a dominance of filtered/treated location recordings, electronic music composition and the more naturalistic use of location recordings. Parts of the work also sonically superimpose audio elements in a way that would be impossible in reality.

A short audio recording that is claimed to be a genuine EVP recording published by The EVP & Transcommunication Society of Great Britain and Ireland is utilised in the work to add an "authentic" EVP element. The short sample is claimed to say "I'll go there.....Hallam....the dead man [sic]" [1] and can be heard in the left and right surround speakers from 0'18" to s 1'03" in the work. Essentially to my ears this recording sounds like static that has abrupt changes in level, nevertheless this is claimed to be genuine.

Based on Jürgenson and Raudive's, work I have also made recordings of tuning a radio receiver from one end of the wavelength-scale to the other and of radio static, in the hope of making my own EVP recordings. I have used this sound as an audio motif throughout the work while also exploring Friedrich Kittler's concept that this could be essentially the purest way to listening to the radio. Kittler states:

> Nobody listens to radio. What loudspeakers or headsets provide for their users is always just radio programming, never radio itself. Only in emergencies, when broadcasts are interrupted, announcers' voices dry up or stations drift away from their proper frequencies, are there any moments at all to hear what radio listening could be about. (Kittler 1993)

As well as exploring the idea of sampling broadcast audio material and feeding this back into the work to create a type of audio media feedback or resonance when it is sequentially broadcast and further transformed by the audio chain and communication system, this work also explores contrasting low fidelity and high fidelity audio aesthetics. The intention is to highlight the fluctuating audio aesthetics of the mediated voice and to create a type of varying mediated "distance" between the listener and the actor's voice. As an artist I am intending that low fidelity aesthetics communicate an increased "distance" in both the "length" or transformative effect of the audio chain and/or communication system (i.e. how many stages or apparatuses the audio has passed through or been transmitted across) and "time" that can be heard as a technological chronological aspect (e.g.

[1] EVP recording (which can be found at http://www.ferio.fsnet.co.uk/wav/Wavweb1_2.wav) was made by Judith Chisholm. "Extract 1: Spirit Voice (male) 18 November 1999: I was alone in my room and asked my friend Jack Hallam (who died in 1986) if he would accompany me somewhere that evening and announce who he is". The EVP & Transcommunication Society of Great Britain and Ireland, "EVP Wav Extracts From Recordings," The EVP & Transcommunication Society of Great Britain and Ireland, http://www.ferio.fsnet.co.uk/WAVEXAMPLES.htm (accessed June 5, 2012).

valve or tube distortion tends towards time stamping sound recording or it sounds like an older recording).

This impressionistic production style for "A Disembodied Voice In [5.1 Surround Sound Radio] Space" with its surreal sound world, heightened sense of sonic perspective, audio segues, poetic story fragments, low fidelity and high fidelity audio aesthetics and media specific self references is explored in the work so as to support the development of the Disembodied Voice.

1.2. Recording Considerations and Methodology

A script was developed for the project and the dialogue was recorded in the Anechoic Chamber at the University of Sydney's Acoustics Laboratory (see Figure 1) to allow for maximum audio manipulation choices when later editing and mixing the recording into the final work. Some of the dialogue and sound effects were also recorded in the Reverberation Room at University of Sydney's Acoustics Laboratory (see Figure 2)[1]. The contrast between the recording styles (i.e. anechoic, reverberant and on location) helped to facilitate a sonic transformation from worldly acoustics to "other" worldly imaged sonic environments. Various surround reverb effects were also applied to the studio dialogue recordings to investigate a range of fabricated acoustic spaces in which to place the voice.



Figure 1. Yanna Black rehearsing script in the Anechoic Chamber at the University of Sydney's Acoustics Laboratory (photo by Colin Black).

[1] NB Only the dialogue recordings made in the anechoic chamber were used in the final work.

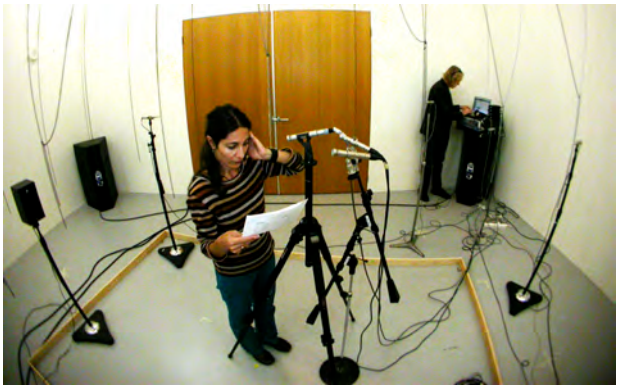


Figure 2. Yanna Black rehearsing script in the Reverberation Room at the University of Sydney's Acoustics Laboratory with Colin Black at the computer preparing to record (photo by Dr. William L. Martens).

The factors that contribute to the overall sonic aesthetic of the unfiltered components for this work include utilizing a Sennheiser MKH 40 microphone (used for the Anechoic Chamber recordings), three Oktava MK-012 microphones (for the Reverberation Room recordings), and two Sennheiser MKH 40 microphones with a Sennheiser MKH 30 microphone (for the surround sound location recordings). These were recorded with a range of devices including a Sound Devices 722 (Portable, High-Resolution Audio Recorder) and Pro Tools software with an MBox2 or 002 audio interface at a sampling rate of 48kHz with a 24 bit depth resolution and PCM encoding.

I chose to record the dialogue in the Anechoic Chamber with a Sennheiser MKH 40 mounted inside a Rycote, Windshield (WS ST AE), which is pictured above on the right in Figure 1. I chose the MKH 40 because it has an exceptionally flat frequency response from 40 to 20,000 Hz (see Figure 3) and therefore adds very little tonal colouration to the recording. In addition to this the MKH 40 has exceptionally low inherent self-noise and high sensitivity specifications,[2] which contribute towards the low level of noise/hiss in the recording of performer, Yanna Black's very quiet, whispered dialogue in sections of the work. The Rycote, Windshield was used instead of a pop shield to reduce the effect of potentially explosive "P" and "B" phonemes in the recording. Further contributing to the transparency of the dialogue recordings was the use of the Sound Devices 722 (Portable, High-Resolution Audio Recorder), which has exceptionally low inherent self-noise pre-amps and analogue to digital converters.[3]

[2] "Equivalent noise level A-weighted (DIN IEC 651)..... 12 (18) dB" and "Sensitivity (free field, no load, 1 kHz)..... 25 (8) mV/Pa ± 1dB". Sennheiser, "MKH 40 Product Sheet," Sennheiser, http://en-de.sennheiser.com/downloads/6316d267e77c057353d4ec766ac77e2e.pdf (accessed June 11, 2012).

[3] "Equivalent Input Noise: Mic: −128 dBu max (−130 dBV), 150 ohm source, 20 Hz–20 kHz BW flat filter, gain fully up". Sound Devices, LLC., 722 High Resolution Digital Audio Recorder User Guide and Technical Information firmware rev. 2.67, (Reedsburg, WI: Sound Devices, LLC., 2011), 69. http://www.sounddevices.com/download/guides/722_en.pdf (accessed June 11, 2012).

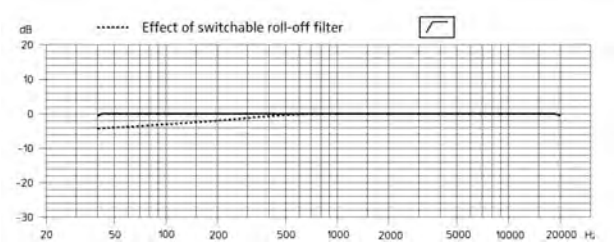


Figure 3. Sennheiser MKH 40 Frequency Response Chart. Sennheiser, "MKH 40 Product Sheet."

I chose to record reverberant sound effects and additional dialogue in the Reverberation Room with the Oktava MK-012 microphones as these microphones have a "presence peak" (see Figure 4) and are effective in articulating the high frequencies of the early reflections in the room. Each microphone was equipped with a cardioid capsule with one microphone facing the performer, while the other two microphones were set up in an ORTF stereo configuration with the pair of cardioids set at an angle of 110˚ and roughly spaced equal to ear spacing (see Figure 2). Tomlinson Holman in his book *Surround Sound* claims that the ORTF stereo has "won over M-S, X-Y, and spaced omnis in blind comparison tests" (Holman 2008) for spatial audio representation, which was also an important consideration. This microphone set up also allowed me to choose between mono and stereo reverberant takes of the performance at various distances from the direct sound source. This set up was recorded using Pro Tools software with a 002 audio interface with its onboard pre-amps.

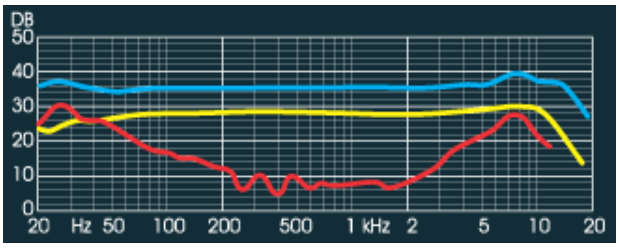


Figure 4. Oktava MK-012 Microphone (with Cardioid Capsule) Frequency Response Chart.

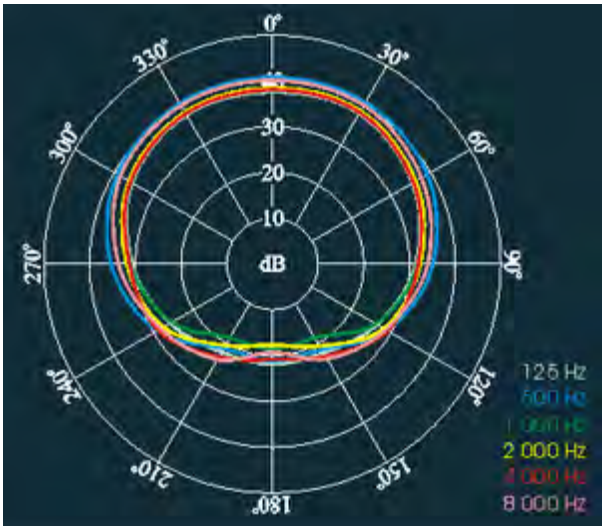


Figure 5. Oktava MK-012 Microphone (Cardioid Capsule) Polar Pattern.

Two locations (Castlereagh Street, Sydney and the interior of a Toyota Corolla) - were recorded using a Double M-S microphone configuration (using two Sennheiser MKH 40, cardioid microphones and one Sennheiser MKH 30, figure of 8 [see figure 6]) onto 3 tracks of a portable recording set up. This portable recording set up consisted of the Sound Devices 722 (Portable, High-Resolution Audio Recorder) with pre-amps and analogue to digital converters for the MKH 40 microphones, which were routed digitally via S/PDIF into channels three and four of the MBox2 and recorded using Pro Tools software running on a MacBook Pro laptop. Additionally, the MKH 30 microphone was connected to the pre-amp of channel two of the MBox2, which was simultaneously recording in Pro Tools. Notably the MKH 30 microphone has almost identical specifications to that of the MKH 40 (except for its figure of eight polar pattern) and was therefore a very suitable companion to this set up to achieve naturalistic, correlated, surround sound location recordings. This was also a practical choice of microphone set up due to the high level of portability needed to make the location recordings. The matrixing of the Double M-S set up was performed after the recording in Pro Tools, to maximize mixing options.

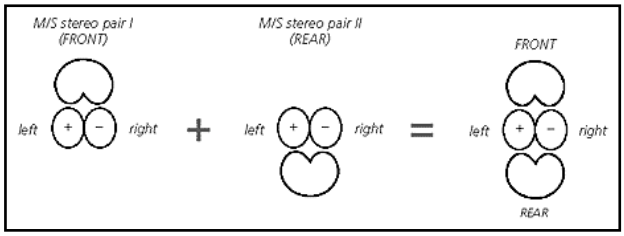


Figure 6. Double MS Recording Setup Schematic. Schoeps Mikrofone, "Double M/S," SCHOEPS GmbH.

ANALYSIS OF THE WORK

"A Disembodied Voice In [5.1 Surround Sound Radio] Space" consists of six contrasting sections, creating surprise throughout the piece. Using the audio segues to vary the pace, together with the varying of textures, spatial aspects, the works fragmented narrative form and unusual theme make it difficult to anticipate what is coming and all work to hold the listener's interest.

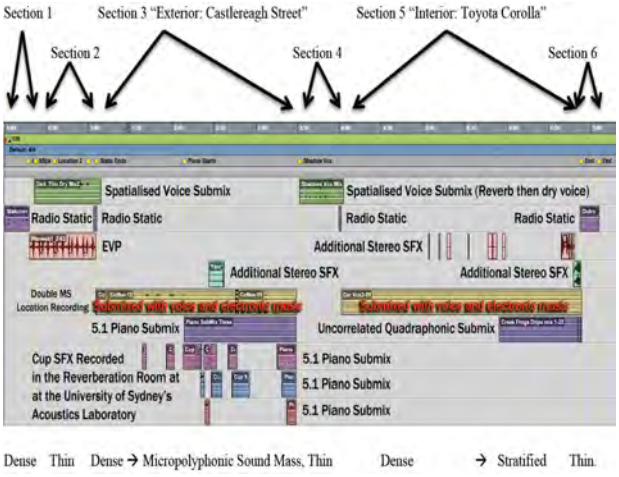


Figure 7. Screen Shot of Final Compilation Pro Tools Session (with Descriptive Labels).

The first sound that is heard in the work is that of multiple electrical switches turning on (indicative of the electricity necessary for the existence of Electronic Voice Phenomena), followed by the establishment of a dense stratified texture of spatialised radio static and recordings of tuning radio receivers from one end of the wavelength-scale to the other. Section 1 introduces the audio motif of radio static and sets up the idea of searching for the Disembodied Voice character in the radiophonic mediated landscape much in the same manner of that of Jürgenson and Raudive. It also pays homage to John Cage's *Imaginary Landscape No. 4* (1951), Stockhausen's *Kurzwellen* (1968), William Basinski's *The River* (2002), and Tod Dockstader's *Aerial* (2003), which all explore, in different ways, the sound of radio reception in their works. Section 1 then segues into our first encounter with the Disembodied Voice character in Section 2 (which has a contrasting thinner texture) using the R360˚ Surround Reverb plug-in in Pro Tools to mask the transition.

In Section 2, the Disembodied Voice is treated so as to make it sound like a low fidelity recording to highlight the electroacoustic perception that there is a type of mediated "distance" between the listener and the actor's voice, with the suggestion of being mediated via EVP from the spiritual world. To achieve this sonic quality, I used Logic Pro's Channel EQ plug-in to remove the low frequencies and high frequencies and left a narrow band around 2kHz to make the voice sound telephonic. I then passed the voice through the Guitar Amp Pro plug-in, which I set to emulate tube distortion, adding a nostalgic tube amplifier effect. I also used the Bus sends to create a wet dry mix, where the wet mix is time delayed by roughly two seconds and further processed using a Spectral Gate plug-in and Sound Designer (convolution reverb) plug-in set to a "Marble Church" impulse response. The panning of this 5.1 wet mix was then automated so as to send this wet mix to a different speaker for each phrase spoken by the performer. The aim was to create a sonically deteriorated reflection of the Disembodied Voice that "appears" to move around the space.

Also heard in the background (in the left and right surround speakers) is the looped EVP recording "I'll go there.....Hallam....the dead man [sic]"[1]. Radio static is then used again at the end of this section to propel the work in a new direction.

Emerging from the abstract electronic aesthetic of Section 2 we arrive suddenly in Section 3's naturalistic, correlated surround sound urban environment of Castlereagh Street in Sydney with its contrasting thicker texture. I chose this location as John Potts's *Castlereagh Street* (2000) was based on the idea that this location was haunted (ABC Classic FM 2000) and in a way I am continuing to sonically search the site for spirits. The electronically generated sounds that start at around 1'26" into the work, during this section, were created from recordings of the Manly Ferry, travelling through the waves near the headlands in 2005, that have been filtered many times using the Spectral Gate plug-in and other audio filters in Logic Pro. I chose to filter this sound, as a number of cultures believe that the dead journey across the waters to reach the Afterlife that is either on an island or in a place under the water.[2]

It is in this section that the Disembodied Voice character starts to realize that something is wrong: "My coffee, I can't taste my morning coffee … [and] The sun's turned cold. I can't feel the warmth of the sunlight on my skin." To highlight this miscorrelation with reality, and to create a kind of heterophonic texture, the phrase "the sun's turned cold" is delayed at various times around the five speakers of the 5.1 surround system (see Figure 8).

[1] The EVP recording entitled "Extract 1: Spirit Voice (male)" by Judith Chisholm can be found at http://www.ferio.fsnet.co.uk/wav/Wavweb1_2.wav. Chisholm states, "Extract 1: Spirit Voice (male) 18 November 1999: I was alone in my room and asked my friend Jack Hallam (who died in 1986) if he would accompany me somewhere that evening and announce who he is". The EVP & Transcommunication Society of Great Britain and Ireland, "EVP Wav Extracts From Recordings," The EVP & Transcommunication Society of Great Britain and Ireland, http://www.ferio.fsnet.co.uk/WAVEXAMPLES.htm (accessed June 5, 2012).

[2] "The Egyptians, whose land was the gift of the river Nile, … believed that the dead crossed over water, and fashioned the hearse in the form of a boat." The 1911 Classic Encyclopedia, "Funeral Rites," LoveToKnow Corp. Inc., http://www.1911encyclopedia.org/Funeral_Rites (accessed June 12, 2012). "Irish traditions tend to envision the Afterlife as being entered through a location which is almost always off to the west (where the sun sets) and usually either an island at sea or a place actually under the water." The Druid Network, "Lesson Twelve ~ Funeral Rites and the Afterlife" The Druid Network, http://druidnetwork.org/learning/courses/online/polytheist/twelve (accessed June 12, 2012).



Figure 8. Pro Tools Session Screen Shot of "Castlereagh Street" Dialogue Surround Sound Delay.

In contrast to the electroacoustic aesthetic qualities of the character's voice in the previous section, minimal processing has been applied to the actor's whispered lines, recorded at very close proximity to lessen the mediated "distance" between the listener and the actor's voice.

The sound effects of the coffee cup, which were recorded in the Reverberation Room, are then superimposed in a spatially incoherent fashion to further illustrate the Disembodied Voice's miscorrelation with reality. We also hear the Disembodied Voice attempting to swallow in frustration.

At this point, five atonal improvised piano parts are spatially placed around the 5.1 surround "sound stage". This already dense texture of pianos is further augmented with an increasing number of improvised atonal piano parts, which are all constrained to the high register of the piano, gradually creating a micropolyphonic sound mass. In earlier experimentation with the 5.1 surround sound system I realised that this type of speaker configuration presented micropolyphonic sound masses in a much more detailed fashion than a stereo system could ever attain and this was one of the reasons why I chose to compose in this style for this project. I was also inspired by Edgard Varèse's notion of spatial sound masses, when he stated, "It was Helmholtz who first started me [Varèse] thinking of music as masses of sound evolving in space, rather than, as I [Varèse] was being taught, notes in some prescribed order" (Varèse 1968).

At the end of this section, the increasing density of the texture is suddenly released into the contrasting thinness of the texture of Section 4, again using the R360˚ Surround Reverb plug-in in Pro Tools to mask the transition.

Spatiality is further deconstructed with the reversing of audio gestures in Section 4, by having the abstracted uncorrelated 5.1 surround sound reverb (with its homogenous heterophonic texture) occurring before the monophonic originating anechoic recording of the actor's voice (see Figure 9). Dr. William L. Martens contributed to this work by preparing the surround sound uncorrelated autoconvolution reverb parts using MATLAB software, which I further enhanced, using the R360˚ Surround Reverb plug-in in Pro Tools.

The script for Section 4, that includes, "Light is like architecture; with it we define space. Without shadows light has no form." thematically questions elements of spatiality. The anechoic recordings of the performer's voice, having no audio reflections, give us no sonic clues to the size of the room in which the voice is recorded. This acoustically communicates a Disembodied Voice in a potentially infinite sized, air filled space. This section closes with the line "Are we shadows in the light? Shadow forms?" after which the audio motif of radio static returns and is again used to propel the work in a new direction.



Figure 9. Pro Tools Session Screen Shot of Surround Sound Reverb Followed by Anechoic Recording.

In Section 5, we seemingly materialise in the interior of a Toyota Corolla, with the sound of rain on its windshield, recorded in surround sound. From this interior perspective we hear the car doors open and close and someone (whom because of the context of the piece we assume is the Disembodied Voice character) fasten their seat belt, start the car and drive off. Combined with this naturalistic soundscape we also hear a recapitulation of the filtered recordings of the Manly Ferry, which were present in Sections 3. As the Disembodied Voice character begins to speak, the sound of the interior of the Toyota Corolla and the actor's voice are filtered by the GRM Comb Filter - "a filter that resonates a selected frequency and all of the harmonics of that frequency" (Chadabe and Favreau n.d.) - and the Reson filter - that "create[s] new sounds from current sounds by rebalancing and redistributing the sound's resonant frequencies" (Ibid).

At around 5'24" an audio gesture of heavy rain drops in the front speakers is filtered and delayed before the same gesture is heard in the left surround and then the right surround speaker. The intention here is to create an artificial sense of forward motion. Other similar gestural responses also occur later in this section.

Water drips that were recorded at very close proximity in an anechoic chamber are placed in the 5.1 surround "sound stage" with added cave-like reverb. I further augmented the mix with two stereo recordings of frogs and creek sounds that I set up as an uncorrelated quadraphonic submix by assigning one stereo recording to the front left and right speakers and the other to the left and right surround speakers. I then slowly increased the overall level of this uncorrelated quadraphonic submix so as to superimpose it onto the interior car

"sound stage", with the intention of creating a stratified texture that has an incredulous relationship with reality. That is, the car continues to sound like it is in motion while it is progressively being submerged in a swamp like environment. Again, this links back to the belief that a number of cultures have, that the dead journey across and sometimes under, the waters to reach the Afterlife.

Section 5 ends with the actor whispering the words "The image of my body disintegrates, with my memories in the rain" and the sound of an ambulance siren followed finally by water bubbles. The idea here is to evoke a sense of emergency, alluding to the Disembodied Voice character being killed in a car accident and the final departure of the Disembodied Voice's spirit from this world.

The work concludes with the 5.1 surround "sound stage" in Section 6 suddenly collapsing with only the front centre speaker emitting the sound of radio static in a final EVP search for the Disembodied Voice. The final sound we hear in the work is that of a single electrical switch being turned off and therefore the EVP search being abandoned.

CONCLUSION

This paper augments the discourse regarding the creation of 5.1 surround sound radio art works and documents a range of the author's creative processes, conceptual standpoints and production techniques in making the aforementioned work. Moreover, by exploring ideas related to the deconstruction of spatiality and fluctuating relationships with sonic "reality" and fiction alongside an increased awareness of electroacoustic perception (that gives us sonic clues to mediated "distance" between the listener and the actor's voice), this paper contributes to the discourse pertaining to media space and the disembodied voice.

In contrast to conventional radio drama (that is typically driven by spoken word dialogue), this work's impressionistic treatment of the phantasmic narrative (where all available audio elements are given more equitable weighting) creates an inclusive delicate sonic framework that invites the listener to immerse his/herself in the works' surround sound environment. Through this immersion the line between sonic "reality" and fiction is increasingly blurred until it becomes believable within the mediated space, that the Disembodied Voice character navigates its identity via the formless body and negotiates instantaneous travel via thought and desire.

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